

HOW TO LEARN TUNES - #2

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #98

In Digging Deeper Jazz video #79, we began this discussion (look back if you haven't seen that video). To recap, learning and memorizing songs is an important skill and pursuit for ALL students of jazz, at all levels. Someone who has the goal of becoming a professional will need to memorize songs, because that is part of the job description - you need to be able to show up and play hundreds of songs with no music stand, no music, no iPad.

For the adult amateur or semi-pro who isn't going to become a full time pro, learning and memorizing songs is still VERY important, but for a different reason. The word "memorize" implies some level of internalization. To memorize something, we need to get it "inside of us." To get good and to sound good, we need to get the songs we are playing inside us. Starting today, you'll have a great approach on how to begin doing this.

Many Songs Share The Same DNA! - here is a partial list of some jazz tunes that share the same "last eight measures." There are hundreds of songs with this set of chords, in this spot of the tune. And notice, the "last eight measures" is fully 25% of a 32 measure tune!

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|--------------------------|-------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| - All Of Me | - In Love In Vain | - Struttin' With Some BBQ |
| - All The Things You Are | - I've Got Your Under My Skin | - Tadd's Delight |
| - But Not For Me | - Just The Way You Are | - The More I See You |
| - Chega De Saudade | - Lucky Southern | - There Will Never Be . . . |
| - I Thought About You | - My Melancholy Baby | - Wave |

The "Last Eight Measures" of MANY Different Tunes

The musical notation consists of two staves. The first staff is a treble clef with a key signature of one flat (Bb). It contains a melodic line with the following notes: F4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), Bb4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), F4 (quarter), and E4 (half). Above the staff are the chords: Fmaj7, Fm7 (or Bb7), Cmaj7, and A7. The second staff is also a treble clef with a key signature of one flat. It contains a harmonic line with the following notes: F4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), Bb4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), F4 (quarter), and E4 (half). Above the staff are the chords: Dm7, G7, and Cmaj7.